

A Full Year On A Single Charge!

Logitech has launched a cordless notebook mouse that promises to be powered for a whole year on a single AA battery charge. The V200 features a battery-light indicator that notifies the user when the batteries are running low. The V200 will cost £34.99 (Rs 2,765).



Podcasts: A Collector's Passion

A filmmaker who has been collecting digital artefacts for 25 years is amassing the world's largest collection of podcasts. Jason Scott, a 34-year-old documentary filmmaker from the Boston area, has saved and catalogued more than 340 GB of online amateur radio since he started in February.



Escape

'HARMFUL INFLUENCES'

China Will Vet Online Games

China seems obsessed with what effect the Internet is having on its youth, as regular readers of this section will recall. Now, Chinese state media say the country will soon release a set of rules to critically evaluate the content of online games as part of a campaign to combat what it sees as harmful influences on the young. Xinhua news agency said the move "is part of the government's efforts to purify the content of online games, prompted by strong public pleas."

Under new rules drawn up by the Ministry of

Culture and the Ministry of Information Industry, released in June, game manufacturers are required to revise game rules that might lead to addiction.

And the government will even endorse clean games to youngsters during the summer vacation! The two ministries will recommend these as healthy "premium games".

"Players of online games are mostly people under 35 years old," Zhang Xinjian, a cultural ministry official, was quoted as saying on June 7. "These people are

prone to the negative influences of sex, violence and other types of unhealthy content in online games."

A report by the cultural ministry quoted the bizarre example of a 13-year-old boy who jumped to his death from a 24-storey building in a flying posture, after leaving a note saying he was joining three friends, who were characters in an online game. We're not sure if it was all the games that led the boy to do what he did, but the report quotes this incident just as though it was.

To put this report and the new rules in perspective, Beijing launched a nationwide crackdown on online computer games last year, banning foreign games with sensitive political content. The Ministry of Culture has already banned 50 electronic games earlier this year, including FIFA Soccer 2005 and Microsoft's Age of Mythology, ostensibly because they are addictive.

And to put the extent of the 'problem' in perspec-

tive: Xinhua said China now has 23 million online game players, a surge from 13.8 million in 2003. Also, China saw sales of online games in 2004 soar 47.9 per cent to 2.47 billion Yuan (Rs 1,300 crore).



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

UNUSABLE!

www.3pjobs.com



"There is no greater imperative for any business, than the necessity of getting right people, in the right jobs. All value creation flows from that." That's a great headline for a job site—but for this job site, the headline is an embarrassment: it's got no jobs to search through!

Even better is the fact that right on the top banner where it says "3P consultants Pvt. Ltd.", they claim they're "Corporate India's First Choice". Huh? With a Web site like this one, with only two clickable links?

Oh yeah, the clickable links. 3P consultants seems to have liaisons of some sort with Penrhyn International, and there's one link to them; we're also to suppose that they're a member of the Association of Executive Search Consultants, to which there's another helpful link.

And that's about all there is on the page. Well, there are several other links as well, such as "Our firm", "Our beliefs", "Clients" and so on, but they're, well, not clickable.

Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? e-mail with subject '**My Desktop**' and your postal address to **mydesktop@thinkdigit.com**, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

The winner receives a copy of 'Webster's New World Computer Dictionary' by Bryan Pfaffenberger, published by IDG Books India (P) Ltd.



Siddharth's desktop is really easy on the eye
Sent in by Siddharth Agarwal, Bangalore